Not everyone is in it for the money, though. For 'changemaker' influencers, it's about doing the right thing. Take environmentalist Malhar Kalambe, for instance, who organises beach clean-ups. Or Siddhesh Lokare (@sidiously), who ties up with brands to help those on the fringes and spotlight stories of everyday heroes. In the case of Revant Himatsingka (@FoodPharmer), revenue comes less from brands and more from speaking engagements for corporates and colleges. More than the views, it's the impact his videos have that matter more to Revant, his most recent success being the CBSE mandating a 'sugar board' in all its schools—highlighting the sugar content in soft drinks—in response to his #SugarBoardMovement. The move even merited a mention in an episode of PM Modi's *Mann Ki Baat* programme.

CREATORS DON'T NEED TO FOLLOW ANY LOGIC OR HIGH STANDARD. ANYTHING AND EVERYTHING GOES. THE TRICK IS TO BE AUTHENTIC

The More the Merrier

It's a myth that India's creator economy is primarily a Gen Z phenomenon or that it has a predominantly metro presence. It's an industry that welcomes everyone. Have a shooting device, an internet connection and a modicum of talent, good or bad, and you're on. Rupali Singh (@sad_rupaa) from West Medinipur in Bengal is happiest when she is creating Insta reels and YT shorts dancing to Hindi songs—her 'Tauba Tauba' jig with her two sons notched up 88.2 million plus views.

Chandni Bhabda's mimicry skills are so impressive that L'Oreal placed her with its brand ambassador Alia Bhatt on a couch and had her imitating the actress pitch-perfectly, to much laughter. "Once I have cracked the voice and the character, I just start rolling," says the 25-year-old, whose love for impersonations dates back to when she'd mimic her teachers at school. From living in rented accommodations for 18 years, Chandni's work on social media today has earned her enough money to buy her own pad in Mumbai suburb Andheri. Says Chandni, "I want to feel



As He Likes It

MADAN GOWRI, *31*
MG SQUAD
CHENNAI

8.17 MN subscribers
2.6 MN followers

Madan Gowri's success proves that far beyond the crowded fields, there are millions of takers for content ranging from physics to politics. And that most prefer it in the vernacular. What started out as an English YouTube channel in 2017 has morphed into a wildly popular Tamil one. Well-researched and pared down without sacrificing complexity, Gowri's entries both slake and spur the thirst for knowledge. However, "you can't just talk about random things," he says. "I focus on what people want to know, like issues in mainstream media."

"Earlier, when you said you are a YouTuber, people thought it was a serious profession," he says. "But today...they are like... 'even my kid is a YouTuber'. The competition is way higher." Proudly prolific, he has put up one video a day for the past 6-7 years. Courtesy his revenues from YouTube, Gowri has 40-50 people on his payroll and runs a digital marketing firm.

Like veteran creator Bhuvan Bam aka BB Ki Vines, Gowri is foraying into films, but says he will never forsake the badge of a content creator. "I'm getting this opportunity as I am who I am in content. The day I stop doing this, I won't have value." ■

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